

A Conversation with J.M. From JSM Cooperative

Q1: Can you provide a brief overview of your book set in A Coruña and the central theme of the story?

A1: Absolutely! "The Man in the Ballcap" is a psychological thriller that unfolds in the captivating city of A Coruña. The central theme revolves around Private Investigator Pepe Miguel's relentless pursuit of a serial murderer who leaves an eerie signature on the bodies of his victims – a brand in the shape of a scallop shell, the symbol for the Camino de Santiago. As he races against time to solve the gruesome murders, readers will be immersed in a world of mystery, dark secrets, and the rich cultural tapestry of Galicia. This gripping narrative promises an electrifying journey through the streets of A Coruña, making it a must-read for anyone seeking an adrenaline-pumping escape into the unknown.

Q2: What inspired you to choose A Coruña as the setting for your book?

A2: I chose A Coruña as the setting for my book because of the rich history in the city, the beautiful architecture, and the intrigue in setting a book in such a foreign city that the majority of readers in the United States have more than likely never heard of it prior to my book. It gives me a chance to share a beautiful place with a wider audience.

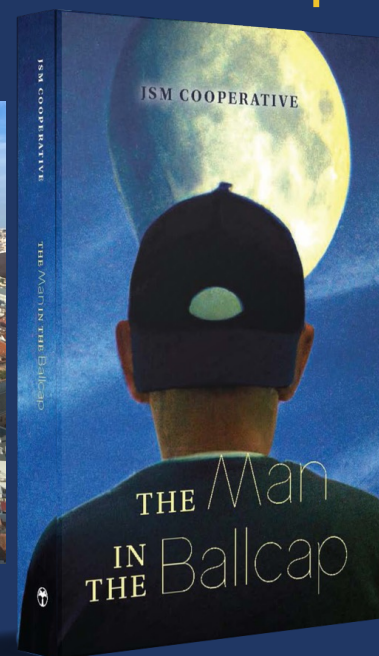
Q3: Can you tell us more about the protagonist and their motivation to solve these murders?

A3: The main protagonist is Pepe Miguel, a widower who was pulled back into the crime scene after leaving the police force following the untimely demise of his late wife. After pouring so much of his time into more petty things, like divorces and uncovering an unfaithful spouse, he was pulled back in at the behest of his long-time friend, Sergio, the lead detective on the Scallop Shell Murderer case.

Q4: The serial murderer in your book wears a baseball cap as their signature. What significance does this detail hold in the story?

A4: I am personally a big fan of baseball, and so when I was trying to produce identifying characteristic that is unique to my antagonist, that I can use to refer to him when I am telling the chapters from his perspective, a baseball cap seemed like the quickest and easiest identifying characteristic that a reader can easily picture in their mind while they read. His face is intentionally omitted on the cover because anyone can be the man in the ballcap if you push them far enough.

THE Man IN THE Ballcap



Q5: Can you tease a pivotal moment or twist that readers can look forward to in the book?

A5: Know this: Not every character in our story will make it to the end, and you might be surprised to find out who our final character standing at the end will be.

Q6: How did you research and develop the psychological profile of the killer in your story?

A6: To get into the mind of The Man in the Ballcap, I read "Mindhunter" and watched hundreds of documentaries on the upbringing of serial killers to understand what drives someone to do horrible things. I do not think a killer is born; I think a killer is made.

Q7: What message or themes do you hope readers will take away from your book?

A7: One of the biggest take-away messages associated with this book is that you can fund research at the intersection of diabetes and Alzheimer's disease with the purchase of a copy. With the support of the rest of the JSM Cooperative, **we have agreed to donate 100% of the proceeds from the sales of this book to Mindful Diabetes Inc**([Click Here to Preorder](#)), a new nonprofit that aims to fund research at the intersection of Type II and III diabetes, investigating holistic therapies in combination with drug therapies to prevent diabetes from progressing to Alzheimer's disease.